

Macro AI Hiring Report - BASF

AI capabilities identified from investment signals

Dataset facts: 12,521 observed postings, 261 AI-core postings, and 182 AI-adjacent postings. The sections below summarize the investment_signal field for AI-core postings only. Counts are observed postings in the dataset, not confirmed hires, budget, capex, or R&D expense.

Manufacturing and Plant Operations Optimization

The company is investing in machine learning, optimization models, and digital twins to enhance plant engineering and production efficiency. Key applications include predictive maintenance AI to optimize plant availability and reduce unplanned downtime, as well as generative AI and computer vision for real-time production monitoring. These initiatives aim to improve asset effectiveness, production reliability, and operational safety through AI-driven decision support in EHSQ (Environment, Health, Safety, and Quality) and manufacturing processes.

Supply Chain and Logistics Intelligence

Investment is directed toward AI-driven predictive modeling and mathematical optimization to refine supply chain management. This includes building "control towers" for predictive and prescriptive decision-making, improving demand forecasting, and optimizing inventory management. Generative AI and agentic systems are being deployed to automate procurement data orchestration and site logistics, with the goal of increasing lead-time prediction accuracy and overall supply chain resilience.

Chemical R&D and Agricultural Innovation

The company is applying Large Language Models (LLMs), deep learning, and advanced AI modeling to accelerate innovation in chemical research and agribusiness. Specific applications include polymer synthesis prediction, digital formulation development, and automotive coatings R&D to reduce lab costs. In agriculture, investments focus on predictive breeding, crop trait optimization, and precision farming tools—such as deep learning for weed detection and image analytics for digital phenotyping—to enhance crop yield and sustainability.

Biometric Security and Computer Vision

Significant resources are being allocated to deep learning and convolutional neural networks for biometric authentication solutions, specifically targeting smartphone, automotive, and industrial applications. These investments focus on face recognition, contactless authentication, and spoof-attack detection to enhance user privacy and device security. Additionally, computer vision and graph neural networks are being developed for driver monitoring systems, 3D LIDAR data processing, and autonomous navigation to improve safety and real-time object detection.

Enterprise AI Transformation and Knowledge Management

The company is building a scalable AI infrastructure, including LLM-based expert systems and agentic AI, to automate internal business processes and workflows. This includes LLM-powered search and knowledge graphs for intellectual property research and patent analysis, as well as generative AI for HR, sales, and marketing decision support. These tools serve to improve data accessibility, accelerate digital transformation, and enhance internal productivity through automated insights and intelligent assistance.

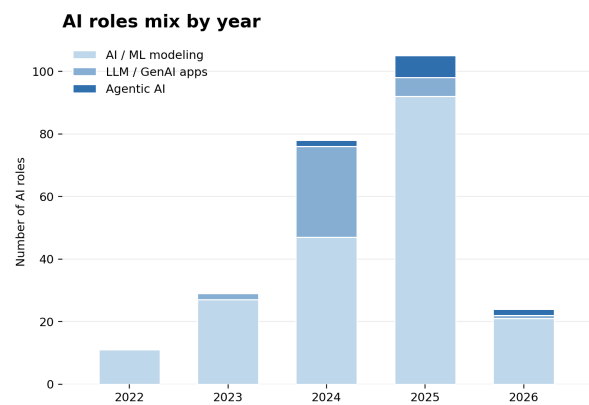
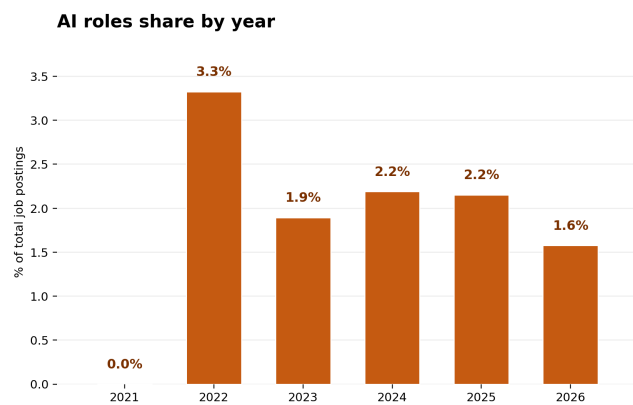
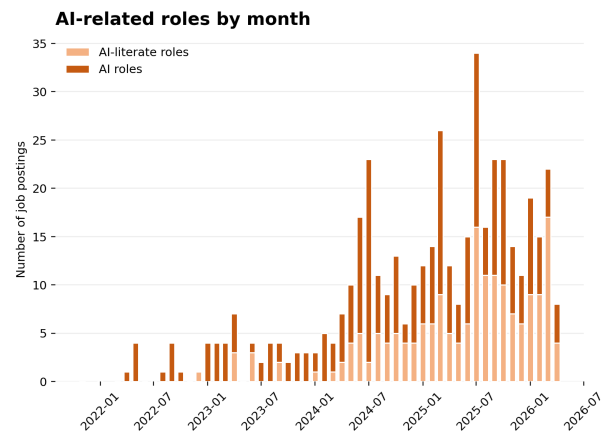
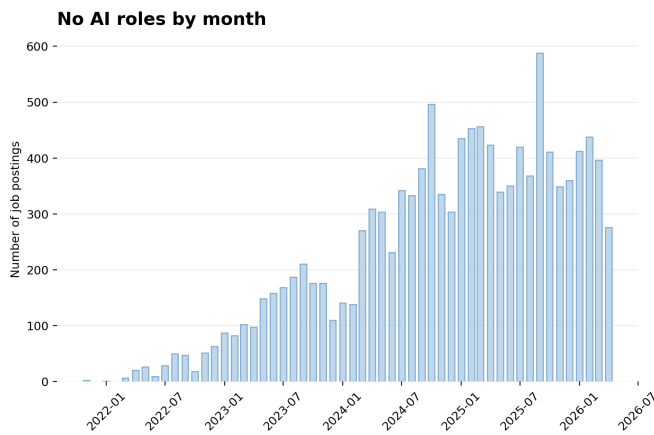
Customer-Facing Digital Commerce

Investment in generative AI, LLMs, and virtual assistants is focused on enhancing the customer experience across digital commerce platforms. These technologies are applied to automate order processing, improve product discovery, and provide intelligent customer service via chatbots and Salesforce Einstein AI. The objective is to drive business growth and innovation by delivering personalized, data-driven interactions for both B2B and B2C customers.

AI Infrastructure and Operational Excellence (MLOps/LLMOps)

To support the deployment of these technologies, the company is investing in MLOps and LLMOps frameworks for scalable AI model lifecycles. This includes building robust infrastructure for LLM deployment, AI security to protect against adversarial attacks, and cloud-based developer platforms (DevHub) to accelerate the delivery of AI solutions. These foundational capabilities are designed to ensure the security, scalability, and efficiency of AI initiatives across the enterprise.

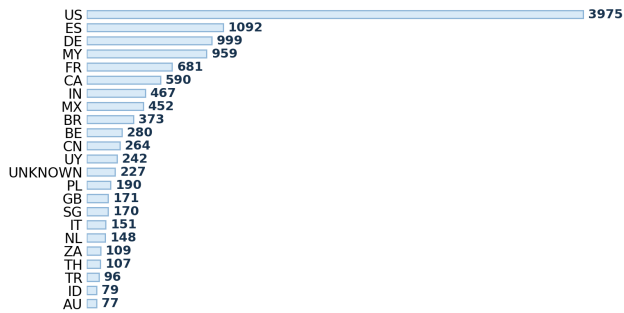
AI hiring trend



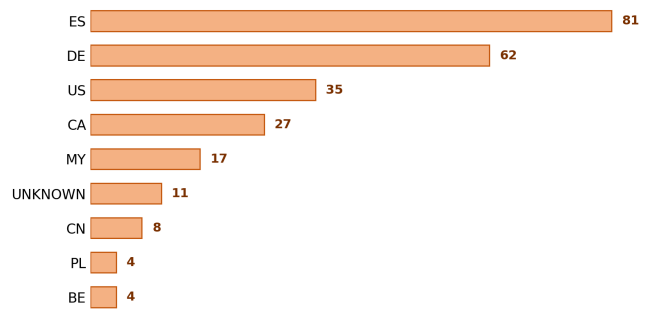
The dataset contains 12521 observed postings. AI-core postings are 261; AI-adjacent postings are 182. Years with AI-related evidence: 2022: AI-core 11/331 (3.3%), AI-adjacent 1/331; 2023: AI-core 33/1742 (1.9%), AI-adjacent 8/1742; 2024: AI-core 81/3700 (2.2%), AI-adjacent 37/3700; 2025: AI-core 111/5160 (2.2%), AI-adjacent 97/5160; 2026: AI-core 25/1586 (1.6%), AI-adjacent 39/1586. AI-core capability mix by year: 2022: AI / ML modeling 11; 2023: AI / ML modeling 27, LLM / GenAI apps 2; 2024: AI / ML modeling 47, LLM / GenAI apps 29, Agentic AI 2; 2025: AI / ML modeling 92, LLM / GenAI apps 6, Agentic AI 7; 2026: AI / ML modeling 21, LLM / GenAI apps 1, Agentic AI 2. Read this page as posting activity over time, not as budget, confirmed hires, or employee share.

AI hiring geography

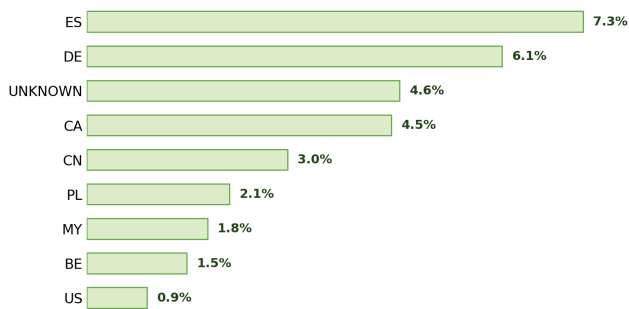
Top hiring countries



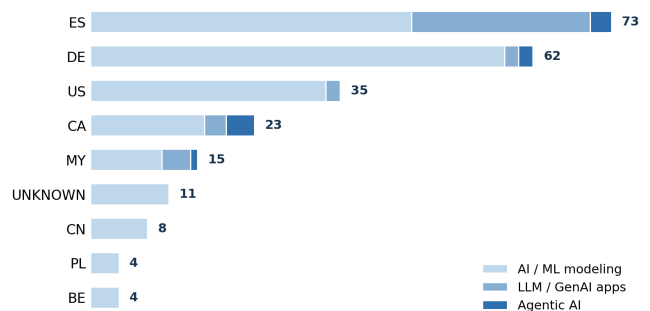
Top countries for AI roles



AI intensity by country

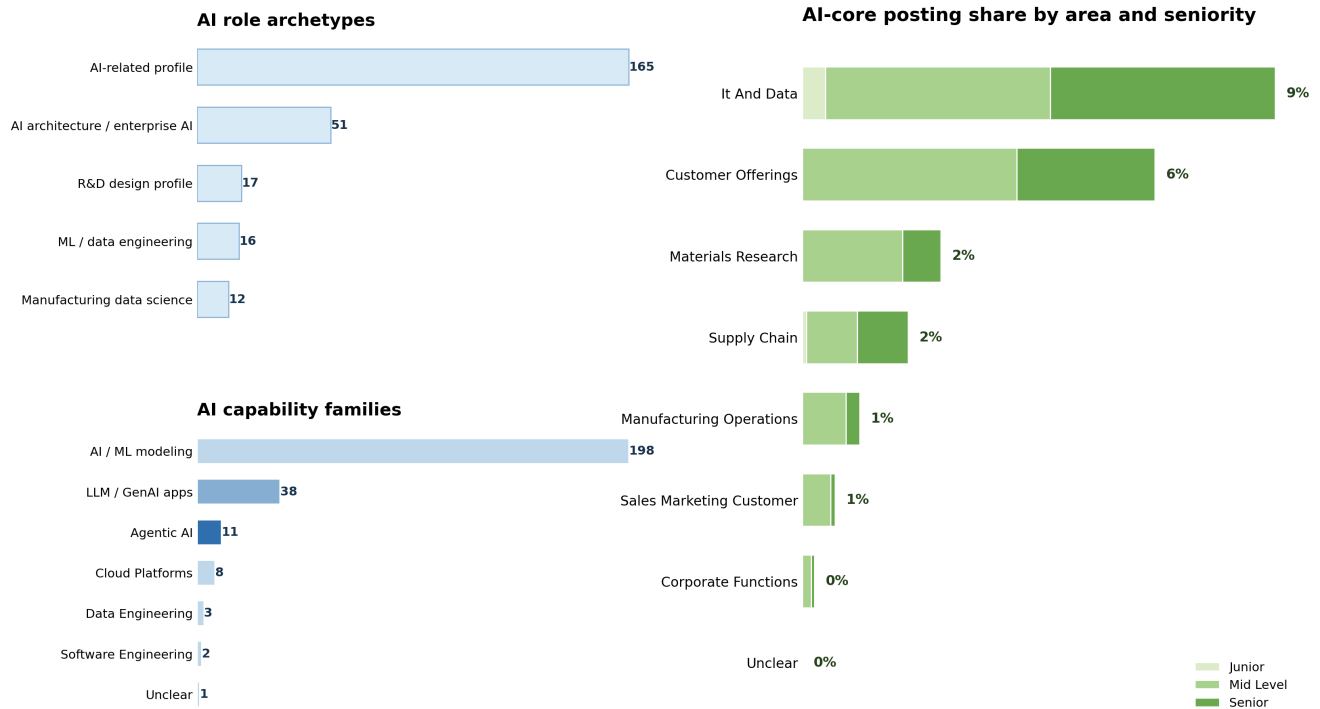


AI role mix in top AI countries



Largest overall posting countries: US 3975; ES 1092; DE 999; MY 959; FR 681; CA 590. Countries with AI-core postings and their denominators: ES: 81/1092 (7.42%); DE: 62/999 (6.21%); US: 35/3975 (0.88%); CA: 27/590 (4.58%); MY: 17/959 (1.77%); UNKNOWN: 11/227 (4.85%); CN: 8/264 (3.03%); BE: 4/280 (1.43%); PL: 4/190 (2.11%); IN: 3/467 (0.64%); AR: 3/46 (6.52%); NL: 2/148 (1.35%); HK: 2/68 (2.94%); BR: 1/373 (0.27%); HR: 1/4 (25.00%). Use the denominators when reading country percentages. A smaller country posting base can produce a higher percentage from a small number of AI-core postings.

AI staffing and seniority



This page replaces skill lists with higher-level staffing information. Role archetypes: AI-related profile: 165; AI architecture / enterprise AI: 51; R&D design profile: 17; ML / data engineering: 16; Manufacturing data science: 12. AI capability families: AI / ML modeling: 198; LLM / GenAI apps: 38; Agentic AI: 11; Cloud Platforms: 8; Data Engineering: 3; Software Engineering: 2; Unclear: 1. Business-area denominators: It And Data 82/962 (8.52%); Customer Offerings 74/1164 (6.36%); Manufacturing Operations 50/4841 (1.03%); Supply Chain 25/1313 (1.90%); Materials Research 18/720 (2.50%); Sales Marketing Customer 8/1365 (0.59%); Corporate Functions 4/1841 (0.22%). Seniority counts inside AI-core postings: Mid Level 157, Senior 99, Junior 5. Use this page to understand the type of profiles being staffed and where they sit in the organization, not to infer budget or employee share.

AI breadth across capability pockets



The matrix locates AI-core postings by capability family and business area. Capability-family counts: Ai MI Modeling 198; Llm Genai Applications 38; Agentic Ai Systems 11; Cloud Platforms 8; Data Engineering 3; Software Engineering 2; Unclear 1. Business-area counts: It And Data 82; Customer Offerings 74; Manufacturing Operations 50; Supply Chain 25; Materials Research 18; Sales Marketing Customer 8; Corporate Functions 4. Nonzero cells: Ai MI Modeling in Customer Offerings: 60; Ai MI Modeling in It And Data: 51; Ai MI Modeling in Manufacturing Operations: 48; Ai MI Modeling in Materials Research: 18; Ai MI Modeling in Supply Chain: 16; Llm Genai Applications in It And Data: 14; Llm Genai Applications in Customer Offerings: 9; Agentic Ai Systems in It And Data: 7; Llm Genai Applications in Sales Marketing Customer: 6; Llm Genai Applications in Supply Chain: 6; Cloud Platforms in It And Data: 5; Ai MI Modeling in Corporate Functions: 3; Cloud Platforms in Customer Offerings: 3; Agentic Ai Systems in Customer Offerings: 2; Agentic Ai Systems in Supply Chain: 2; Ai MI Modeling in Sales Marketing Customer: 2; Data Engineering in It And Data: 2; Llm Genai Applications in Manufacturing Operations: 2; Software Engineering in It And Data: 2; Data Engineering in Supply Chain: 1; Llm Genai Applications in Corporate Functions: 1; Unclear in It And Data: 1. Read the bubbles as a map of where the observed AI-core postings sit, not as project size, budget, or strategic priority.

Appendix: brief label guide

Score 0 means no explicit AI-role signal. A posting can still be technical and remain score 0. Score 1 means AI-adjacent: AI is mentioned, but it is not the core responsibility of the role. Score 2, called AI-core in this report, means AI, ML, LLMs, GenAI, MLOps, or related AI capability is explicit and central to the role. Primary category describes the capability family, such as AI / ML modeling, LLM / GenAI applications, agentic AI systems, industrial automation, enterprise systems, or materials-science R&D. Business area describes the organizational context, such as IT and data, manufacturing operations, materials research, supply chain, customer offerings, sales and marketing, or corporate functions. Counts are observed postings in the enriched dataset. They are not confirmed hires, employee counts, budgets, capex, or R&D expense.